



Star Photo

EVA BEIHOFFER, FAN EXTRAORDINARY

Swings a mean ladle, too

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SHE'S 59, BUT

Eva Beihofer Rated Miller Fan Fixture

By MAX NICHOLS
Minneapolis Star Staff Writer

Baseball, the Millers, Metropolitan stadium and home are interchangeable words as far as Eva Beihofer is concerned.

Eva has been making herself at home at Miller home games for 34 years. At every game she sits directly behind third base. She has her scorebook. And she's there, rain or shine.

"I missed only three games last year and three the year before that," she said. "I don't think I've missed over six games in any one year for the past 15 years. I grew up in the game."

That means Eva averages over 70 games a year. The 59-year-old Minneapolis woman works as a cook for St. Andrew's hospital. She rides the bus to every game.

She has been working at St. Andrew's for 28 years, so they understand when she wants off an hour early for an afternoon game.

Miller ball players recognize Eva, too.

She was sitting behind third base in the early 1930s at Nicollet park when Andy Cohen was a Miller. In 1958,

when Cohen came to Metropolitan stadium as Denver's manager, one of the first things he did was to come over and say hello to Eva.

"He asked about all the others who used to sit behind third base," she said. "I wouldn't know what the game looks like from anywhere else."

Eva meant it when she said she grew up in the game. Her father, Willard (Red) Richardson, played, managed and umpired baseball in New Auburn, Minn. Eva once had to take his place as an umpire.

"I was in high school with some of the players on the team," she said. "So I caught it on the close plays."

Eva lives alone. She often takes her grandchildren, Shirley, Jim and Gordon Peterson, to the games. She keeps a collection of about 660 statues of elephants, but right in the middle is a baseball autographed by the Boston Red Sox.

When the Millers open against Dallas-Fort Worth at 2:30 p.m., April 22, Eva will be there.

"I've only missed one opening day in 34 years," she said. "I won't miss another one."